MFANO BANK

A fictional bank for a portfolio project

STAFF POLICY

Annual leave

Reference	HR-POL-03
Version	2
Status	Live
Effective date	2026-03-01
Owner	Human Resources
Approved by	Head of Human Resources
Classification	Internal

This document is fictional. It does not describe the procedures of any real bank.

Document control

What changed in version 2: Leave is applied for in the HR system instead of on paper, the notice period is 7 days instead of 14, and up to 5 days (instead of 10) may be carried forward.

Version history

Version	Effective date	Change
1	2023-01-01	First issue
2	2026-03-01	Leave applied for in the HR system; notice cut to 7 days; carry-forward cut to 5 days

Approval and distribution

Approved by the Head of Human Resources. Owned by Human Resources. Distributed to all branches through the intranet. Printed copies are not controlled; always check the intranet for the current version.

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1. Purpose

This policy sets out how staff plan, apply for and take annual leave, so that staff rest and branches keep enough cover to serve customers safely.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all permanent staff. Staff on fixed-term contracts follow the leave terms in their contracts.

3. Definitions

- **Annual leave:** paid leave for rest, separate from sick, maternity, paternity and compassionate leave.
- **Line manager:** the manager the staff member reports to; for branch staff, usually the branch manager or supervisor.
- **HR system:** the bank's human resources system used to apply for and approve leave.
- **Authorised signatory:** a staff member authorised to approve transactions above teller limits.
- **Leave year:** the calendar year from 1 January to 31 December.

4. Roles and responsibilities

- **Staff member:** plans leave early and applies in the HR system.
- **Line manager:** approves or declines leave in the HR system and keeps enough cover.
- **Branch manager:** confirms branch cover before approving leave for branch staff.
- **Human Resources:** maintains leave balances and this policy.

5. Procedure

5.1 Entitlement

Permanent staff are entitled to 28 working days of annual leave per leave year. Staff joining during the year receive a proportional entitlement.

5.2 Applying for leave

Apply for annual leave in the HR system at least 7 days before the first day of leave. Your line manager approves or declines the request in the HR system. Paper leave forms are no longer accepted.

5.3 Approval and branch cover [MANDATORY CONTROL]

Before approving leave for branch staff, the branch manager confirms that the branch keeps at least two authorised signatories on duty on every day of the leave.

5.4 Carrying leave forward

Up to 5 unused days may be carried into the next leave year. They must be taken by 31 March, after which they lapse. Unused leave is not paid out except when a staff member leaves the bank.

5.5 Changing or cancelling approved leave

To change or cancel approved leave, submit the change in the HR system before the leave starts. Your line manager approves the change.

5.6 Public holidays during leave

Public holidays that fall during approved annual leave are not counted as leave days.

5.7 Recall from leave

In an emergency, the branch manager may recall a staff member from leave with Human Resources' approval. The days not taken are restored to the staff member's balance.

6. Exceptions and escalation

- **Less than 7 days' notice:** possible only for emergencies, with the line manager's approval recorded in the HR system.
- **HR system unavailable:** email the request to your line manager and enter it in the HR system when it is available.

7. Records and retention

Leave records: 7 years after the staff member leaves the bank. Records are kept in the branch file room or the document management system and destroyed only under the bank's records retention schedule. Records that are part of an open complaint, dispute, audit or investigation are kept until it is closed.

8. Monitoring and quality assurance

Back office quality assurance reviews a sample of files every month against this policy and reports exceptions to the branch manager and to Human Resources. Repeated exceptions at a branch are reported to the Head of Branch Operations. Internal audit may review compliance with this policy at any time.

9. Related documents

- HR-POL-01 Staff code of conduct
- HR-POL-07 Salary advance and staff loans

Appendix A: Frequently asked questions

Q1. How early must I apply for annual leave?

At least 7 days before the first day of leave, in the HR system.

Q2. How many unused days can I carry into next year?

Up to 5 days, to be taken by 31 March.

Q3. Can I still use the paper leave form?

No. From version 2 all leave is applied for in the HR system.